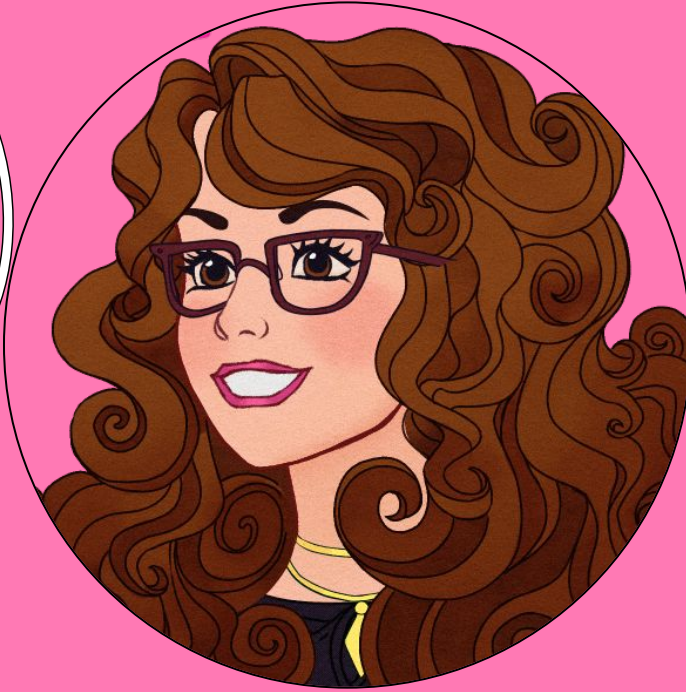


A vibrant, psychedelic border surrounds the central text. It features thick, swirling lines in shades of pink, orange, yellow, and red. Interspersed among these swirls are various stylized flowers: a green daisy-like flower with a white center in the top left, a white daisy in the bottom left, a yellow flower with a purple center in the middle right, and a white daisy in the top right. Small white and colored dots are scattered throughout the background.

Patriarchy in Pastels:

*Cozy Game Culture &
feminist Gameplay*



ADELINE K. PIERCY

she/them

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I also teach at MacEwan University in Professional Communications!



MY JOURNEY THROUGH POST-SECONDARY

01 *BSc. in Biological Sciences, Classical Studies Minor*

02 *BCS Professional Communications*

03 *MA Digital Humanities*

MY RESEARCH

This presentation covers my ongoing thesis research, but I've been working on other projects, too!

- ★ Presenting at CGSA
- ★ Controlling Catastrophe: Indoor Gameplay to Support Sensory Dysfunction [Video Essay]
- ★ Min-Maxing Relaxing: Playtime and Privilege in the Post-Pandemic
- ★ Making fun games (see website)



HOW MY RESEARCH PROGRESSED

- ★ *Why does my (ex) partner play Stardew Valley so differently from me?*
- ★ *What are the gendered differences in cozy game play?*
- ★ *Why are there gendered elements in cozy games in the first place?*





METHODOLOGIES

- ★ I make sense of my own experience using **autoethnography** (critical reflection on my own experiences) and **discourse analysis** (looking at media in social contexts).
- ★ Queer theory and digital humanities methodologies, including “close play” through the lens of gender and semiotic analysis of public game streams.

What Is a "Girl Game"?

- ★ Edu-tainment (*Nancy Drew*)
- ★ Socializing Games (*Barbie* anything)
- ★ Dress Up (*Barbie Fashion Designer*)
- ★ Mobile Games (*Candy Crush*)
- ★ Knitting Games (literally)
- ★ Domestic- or Job-oriented Games (*Diner Dash*)

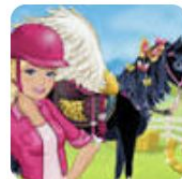


Game Kid Game

<http://www.gamekidgame.com> › [barbie](#) › [barbie_games](#)

Barbie Games For Girls

Collection of **free online Barbie Games** and activities for girls. Dress up and play with Barbie doll on Gamekidgame.com.



LITERATURE

SHIRA CHESS (2017)

- ★ Games developed for women repurpose women's leisure practices into digital play.
- ★ The idea of what "women gamers" are is oversimplified into a "**designed identity.**"
- ★ As such, girl games have tended to be narrative-driven rather than based on skill and mechanics.

AMANDA COTE (2020)

- ★ "**Hardcore**" games: skill-based, and *"prioritize a version of hegemonic masculinity based on an ideal of toughness, aggression, and dominance."*
- ★ Casual games are not included!

What Makes a Game "Cozy"?



The image features a vibrant pink background with a psychedelic border on the left and right sides. The border consists of thick, wavy lines in shades of purple, orange, yellow, and green. Interspersed within these lines are small, stylized flowers in yellow, pink, and white, along with small colored circles (red, green, orange, white).

My Hot Take?

Cozy Games Are "Girl
Games", *Rebranded*



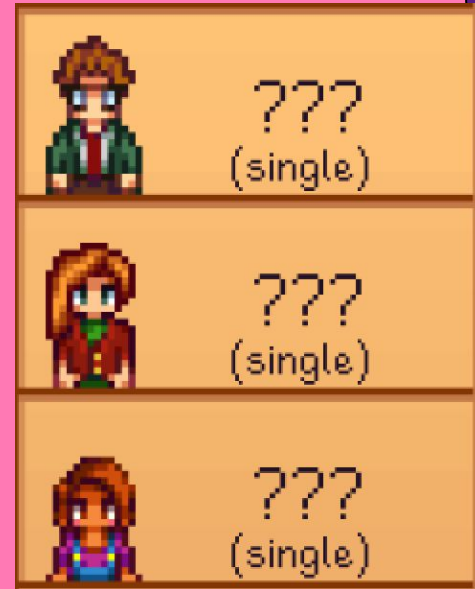
But Adeline, everyone can play cozy games! They're not just for women.



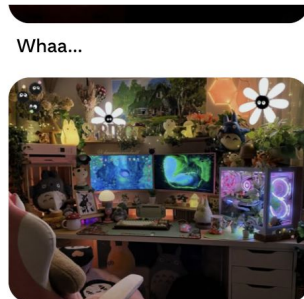
Values in Cozy Games

Cozy games often include:

- ★ Capitalism
- ★ Colonialism (here is your new piece of land!)
- ★ Gender binaries
- ★ Assumed heterosexuality
- ★ Consumerism



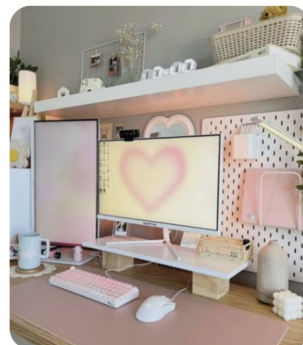
THE GIRL GAMER SPACE



gaming corner / desk area



Studio Ghibli-Inspired Gaming



Aesthetic Desk Makeover Ideas



*SO, WHAT ARE SOME VALUES OF
WOMEN AND GENDER-DIVERSE FOLKS
THAT WE MIGHT SEE IN GAMES?*

**WHAT WOULD AN
ANTI-CAPITALIST,
DECOLONIAL, OR
GENDER-INCLUSIVE
COZY GAME
LOOK LIKE?**



Takeaways!

- ★ Look at historical patterns in game development
- ★ Think about what values are represented in your cozy games while you play!
- ★ Inclusive game design requires changing the foundations of games, not just the aesthetics.

